

GlobalTrust Financial Services

Customer Complaint Handling Standard Operating Procedure

Customer Experience Department

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1. Purpose

This Customer Complaint Handling Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) establishes consistent processes for receiving, investigating, resolving, and reporting customer complaints at GlobalTrust Financial Services (GTFS). Effective complaint handling supports our average customer satisfaction target of 95%.

- **Customer trust** — Timely acknowledgement and transparent resolution build loyalty.
- **Regulatory compliance** — Meet MAS and consumer protection requirements.
- **Service quality** — Identify and address systemic service failures.
- **Operational improvement** — Root cause analysis drives process enhancements.
- **Customer retention** — Fair resolution reduces attrition and reputational harm.

BEST PRACTICE: Every complaint must be logged in the central Complaint Management System (CMS) before investigation begins. Verbal complaints count — document immediately.

2. Scope

- Retail Banking, Commercial Banking, Mortgage Services, Digital Banking.
- Call Center, Email Support, Branches, Relationship Managers, Customer Experience Team.
- All GTFS employees who receive or handle customer feedback or complaints.
- Cross-functional coordination with Operations, Compliance, Legal, and product teams.

3. Complaint Categories

Category	Description	Typical Owner	Related SOP
Service Quality	Wait times, responsiveness, communication	Branch / Call Center	—
Account Issues	Incorrect balances, statement errors	Operations	—
Loan Processing	Delays, incorrect decisions, documentation	Loan Operations	GTFS-OPS-001
Mortgage Processing	Valuation, legal, settlement delays	Mortgage Operations	GTFS-OPS-002
Digital Banking	App errors, login failures, feature issues	Digital Banking	GTFS-SEC-001
ATM Issues	Cash not dispensed, card retained	ATM Operations	—
Fraud	Unauthorized transactions, identity theft	Fraud / AML	GTFS-COMP-001
Unauthorized Transactions	Disputed card or account debits	Card Operations	GTFS-COMP-001
Staff Conduct	Rude behaviour, mis-selling, discrimination	HR / Branch Manager	GTFS-HR-001
Fees & Charges	Incorrect or unexpected fees	Operations / Product	—

4. Complaint Severity Levels

Level	Classification	Examples	Business Impact	Escalation
Level 1	Minor	Single fee dispute; minor delay	Low; isolated incident	Complaint Officer

Level	Classification	Examples	Business Impact	Escalation
Level 2	Moderate	Loan delay; repeated service failure	Medium; customer dissatisfaction	Branch Manager + CX
Level 3	Major	Mortgage settlement failure; data breach	High; financial/reputational damage	CX Director + Compliance
Level 4	Critical	Systemic outage; regulatory breach	Critical; regulatory/media risk	Executive Committee
Level	Acknowledgement SLA	Resolution SLA	RCA Required	Approval
Level 1 — Minor	Within 4 business hours	3 business days	No	Complaint Officer
Level 2 — Moderate	Within 2 business hours	5 business days	Recommended	Customer Service Manager
Level 3 — Major	Within 1 business hour	10 business days	Mandatory	Operations Manager / CX Director
Level 4 — Critical	Within 30 minutes	15 business days	Mandatory	Executive Committee

IMPORTANT: Root Cause Analysis is mandatory for Level 3 and Level 4 complaints. Escalate within 30 minutes if an SLA breach is expected.

5. Complaint Lifecycle

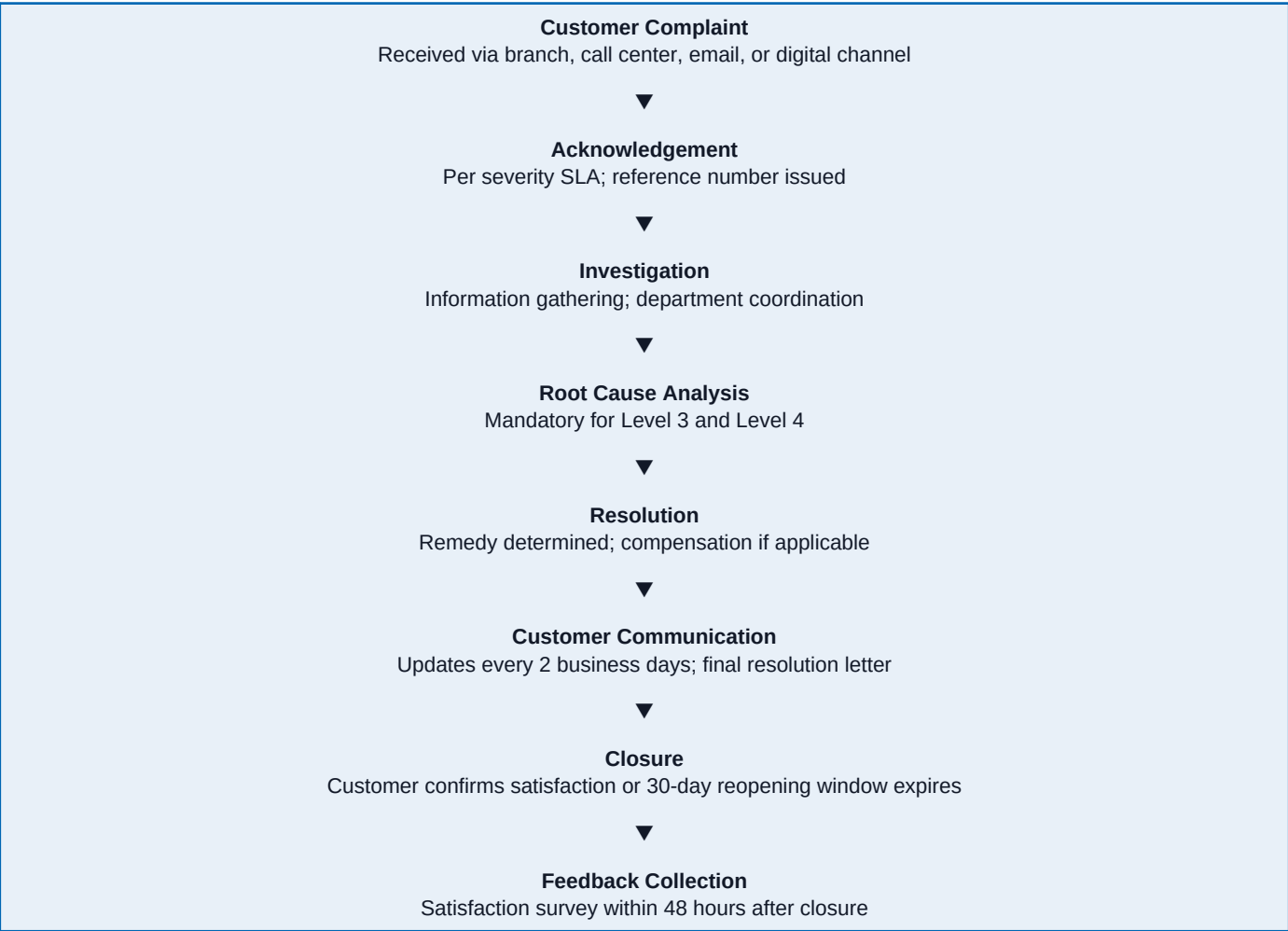


Figure — Level 2 Complaint Resolution Timeline

Hour 0 Complaint logged	+2 hrs Acknowledgement (L2)	Day 1–3 Investigation	Every 2 days Customer update	Day 5 Resolution (L2 SLA)	+48 hrs Survey sent
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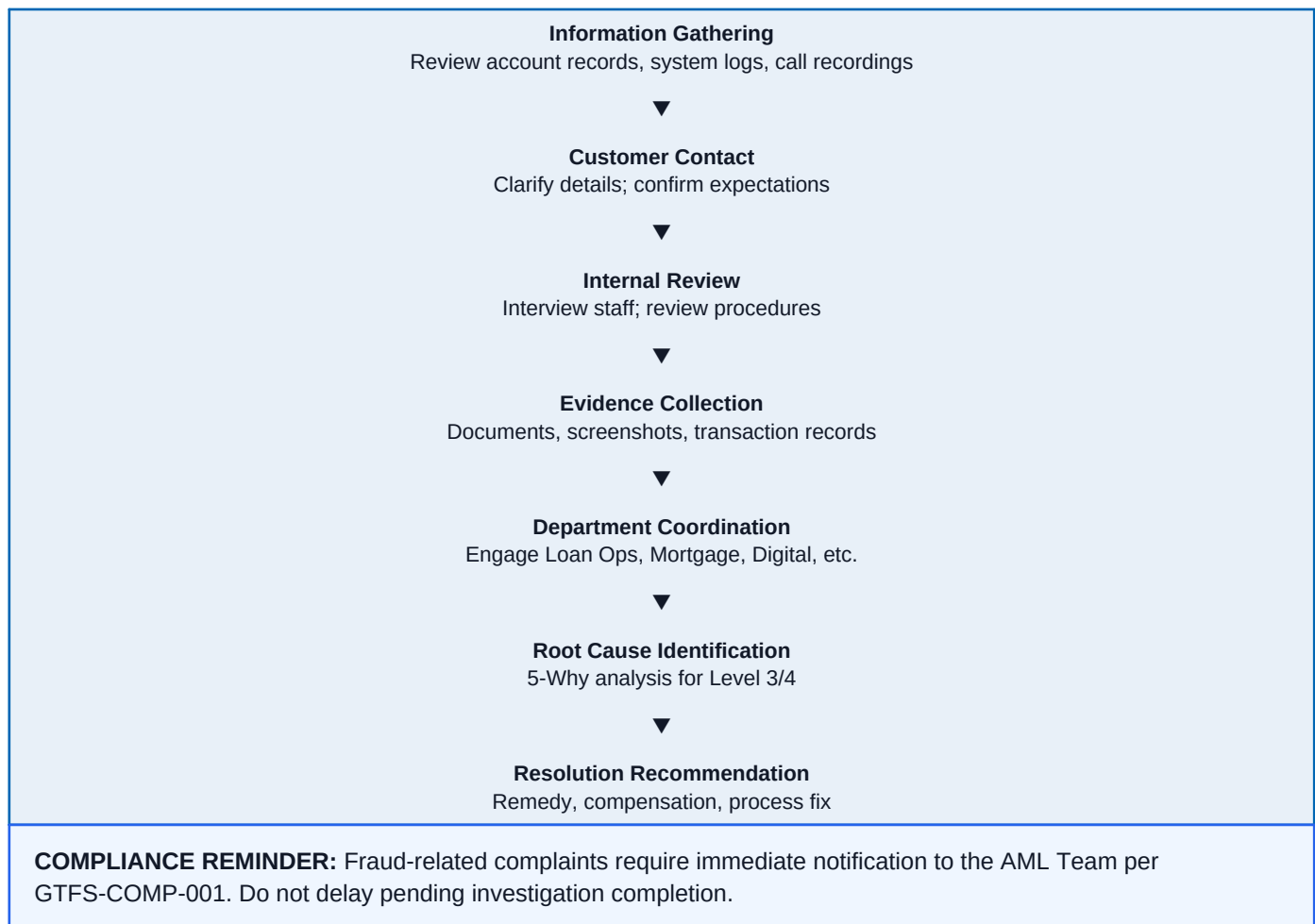
6. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Customer Service Representative	Log complaint; initial triage; Level 1 acknowledgement within 4 hours
Complaint Officer	Investigate; coordinate departments; recommend resolution
Branch Manager	Escalation point for branch complaints; staff conduct issues
Operations Manager	Complex operational complaints; compensation up to SGD 2,000
Compliance	Regulatory complaints notified within 2 hours; fraud coordination
Legal	Legal threats; litigation risk; regulatory correspondence

Role	Responsibilities
Customer Experience Director	Level 3 oversight; compensation up to SGD 10,000
Executive Committee	Level 4 complaints; compensation above SGD 10,000

7. Investigation Process

Root Cause Analysis Process



8. Escalation Matrix

Figure — Complaint Escalation Decision Tree

Complaint Received

▼ Classify Severity

Level 1 Minor → CSR / Complaint Officer

Level 2 Moderate → Complaint Officer + Branch Manager

Level 3 Major → Customer Experience + Compliance

Level 4 Critical → Executive Committee + Legal

▼ Special Categories

Fraud → Immediately notify AML Team (GTFS-COMP-001)

Regulatory → Notify Compliance within 2 hours

▼ SLA Breach Expected?

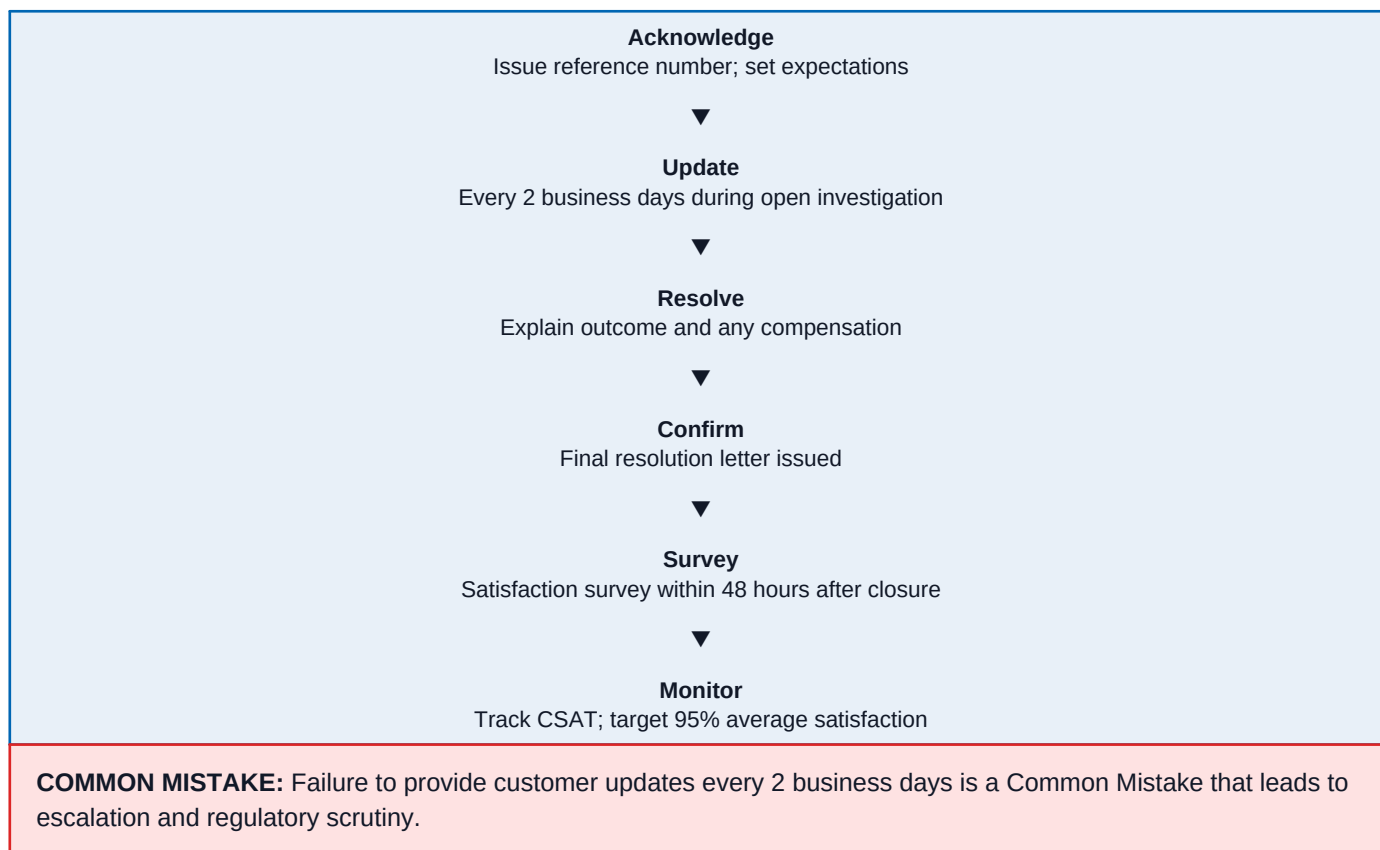
Yes → Escalate within 30 minutes

Escalation Path	Trigger	Notify	Timeline
Branch → Regional Office	Unresolved after 48 hours at branch	Regional CX Manager	Same day
Regional → Customer Experience	Level 2+ or repeat complainant	CX Director	Within 4 hours
CX → Compliance	Regulatory concern; conduct issue	Compliance Officer	Within 2 hours
Compliance → Legal	Legal threat; litigation risk	Legal Counsel	Within 4 hours
CX → Executive Management	Level 4; media risk; systemic failure	CEO / ExCo	Within 30 minutes
Compensation Authority	Maximum Amount	Conditions	
Customer Service Manager	SGD 500	Level 1–2; documented goodwill	
Operations Manager	SGD 2,000	Level 2–3; service failure confirmed	
Customer Experience Director	SGD 10,000	Level 3; significant impact	
Executive Committee	Above SGD 10,000	Level 4; Board notification may apply	

9. Customer Communication

Communication Type	When Used	Standard	Owner
Acknowledgement Email	Upon complaint logging	Reference number; SLA; contact details	CSR / Complaint Officer
Progress Update	During investigation	Every 2 business days minimum	Complaint Officer
Telephone Communication	Complex or urgent complaints	Document call summary in CMS	Complaint Officer
Escalation Notification	When escalated to Level 3	Explain escalation; new contact	CX Team
Final Resolution Letter	Upon closure	Outcome; remedy; reopening rights (30 days)	Complaint Officer

Customer Communication Flow



10. Quality Assurance

- **Complaint Audits** — Monthly random sample review of closed complaints.
- **Customer Satisfaction Surveys** — Sent within 48 hours after closure; target 95%.
- **Root Cause Analysis** — Mandatory for Level 3 and Level 4; tracked to completion.
- **Trend Reporting** — Quarterly trend analysis mandatory; presented to ExCo.
- **Continuous Improvement** — Monthly Complaint Review Meeting (first Monday of every month).

QA Activity	Frequency	Owner	Output
Complaint audit sample	Monthly	CX QA Team	Audit report

QA Activity	Frequency	Owner	Output
Monthly Complaint Review Meeting	First Monday monthly	CX Director	Action items
Quarterly trend analysis	Quarterly (mandatory)	CX Analytics	Trend report to ExCo
SLA compliance dashboard	Weekly	Operations	SLA breach alerts
CSAT tracking	Ongoing	CX Team	95% target monitoring

11. Regulatory Compliance

- **Financial regulations** — MAS Fair Dealing Guidelines; timely complaint handling.
- **Consumer protection** — Transparent resolution; written final response.
- **Privacy requirements** — Customer data handled per GTFS-SEC-001.
- **Record retention** — Complaint records retained for 7 years.
- **Audit readiness** — Complete CMS records; RCA documentation for Level 3/4.

COMPLIANCE REMINDER: Regulatory complaints must be notified to Compliance within 2 hours of classification. Complaint reopening window is 30 calendar days from closure.

Complaint Handling Case Studies

Case Study: ATM Cash Not Dispensed

Customer Issue: Customer withdrew SGD 500; ATM debited account but did not dispense cash.

Investigation: ATM journal reviewed; transaction confirmed. Level 1 complaint logged.

Root Cause: ATM dispenser malfunction; hardware fault identified.

Resolution: Account credited SGD 500 within 24 hours. Apology letter issued.

Timeline: Acknowledged in 3 hours. Resolved in 2 business days (Level 1 SLA: 3 days).

Lessons Learned: ATM reconciliation process triggered; vendor notified for repair.

Case Study: Delayed Mortgage Approval

Customer Issue: Customer complained mortgage approval exceeded 7-day SLA per GTFS-OPS-002.

Investigation: Mortgage file reviewed; legal verification delayed due to incomplete title documents.

Root Cause: Customer submitted incomplete title pack; internal handoff delay between Legal and Credit.

Resolution: Expedited processing; SGD 200 goodwill (Customer Service Manager authority).

Timeline: Level 2 complaint. Acknowledged in 1 hour. Resolved in 4 business days.

Lessons Learned: Cross-reference mortgage complaints to GTFS-OPS-002 SLA standards.

Case Study: Unauthorized Card Transaction

Customer Issue: Customer reported SGD 3,200 unauthorized online transaction.

Investigation: Card blocked immediately. Fraud team engaged. AML Team notified per GTFS-COMP-001.

Root Cause: Compromised card credentials; merchant located overseas.

Resolution: Provisional credit issued. Full investigation completed. Charge reversed.

Timeline: Level 3 complaint. Fraud escalated immediately. Resolved in 8 business days.

Lessons Learned: Fraud-related complaints bypass standard SLA for initial AML notification.

Case Study: Incorrect Fees Charged

Customer Issue: Customer charged SGD 85 annual fee despite fee waiver promotion.

Investigation: Account history reviewed; promotion code not applied at account opening.

Root Cause: System configuration error in promotional fee waiver batch.

Resolution: Fee reversed. SGD 50 goodwill (within Customer Service Manager SGD 500 limit).

Timeline: Level 1. Acknowledged in 4 hours. Resolved in 1 business day.

Lessons Learned: Batch fee errors require Level 3 RCA if affecting multiple customers.

Case Study: Poor Branch Service

Customer Issue: Customer reported rude treatment by branch staff during account opening.

Investigation: Branch Manager interviewed staff; CCTV and queue records reviewed.

Root Cause: Staff member under stress during peak period; inadequate de-escalation training.

Resolution: Written apology from Branch Manager. Staff coaching per GTFS-HR-001.

Timeline: Level 2. Acknowledged in 2 hours. Resolved in 3 business days.

Lessons Learned: Staff conduct complaints require HR notification and documented remediation.

Case Study: Digital Banking Outage

Customer Issue: Multiple customers unable to access mobile banking for 6 hours.

Investigation: Incident linked to planned maintenance overrun. Level 4 complaint classification.

Root Cause: Change management failure; inadequate customer communication before outage.

Resolution: Mass notification sent. RCA completed. Process fix implemented.

Timeline: Level 4. Acknowledged in 20 minutes. Resolution in 12 business days.

Lessons Learned: Systemic outages always Level 4; Executive Committee notified within 30 minutes.

12. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Level 1 acknowledgement SLA?

A: Within 4 business hours.

Q: Level 2 acknowledgement SLA?

A: Within 2 business hours.

Q: Level 3 acknowledgement SLA?

A: Within 1 business hour.

Q: Level 4 acknowledgement SLA?

A: Within 30 minutes.

Q: Level 1 resolution SLA?

A: 3 business days.

Q: Level 2 resolution SLA?

A: 5 business days.

Q: Level 3 resolution SLA?

A: 10 business days.

Q: Level 4 resolution SLA?

A: 15 business days.

Q: How often must customers be updated?

A: Every 2 business days during open complaints.

Q: Customer Service Manager compensation limit?

A: SGD 500.

Q: Operations Manager compensation limit?

A: SGD 2,000.

Q: Customer Experience Director compensation limit?

A: SGD 10,000.

Q: Executive Committee compensation?

A: Above SGD 10,000.

Q: Complaint record retention?

A: 7 years.

Q: When is the satisfaction survey sent?

A: Within 48 hours after closure.

Q: When is RCA mandatory?

A: Level 3 and Level 4 complaints.

Q: When is the Monthly Complaint Review Meeting?

A: First Monday of every month.

Q: Quarterly trend analysis?

A: Mandatory.

Q: When to escalate for SLA breach?

A: Within 30 minutes if breach is expected.

Q: Fraud complaint handling?

A: Immediately notify AML Team per GTFS-COMP-001.

Q: Regulatory complaint notification?

A: Notify Compliance within 2 hours.

Q: Average customer satisfaction target?

A: 95%.

Q: Complaint reopening window?

A: 30 calendar days from closure.

Q: Where are loan complaint SLAs defined?

A: GTFS-OPS-001 Loan Approval SOP.

Q: Where are mortgage complaint SLAs defined?

A: GTFS-OPS-002 Mortgage Processing Guide.

13. Appendices

Appendix A — Complaint Classification Matrix

Refer to Sections 3 and 4 for category and severity classification.

Appendix B — Escalation Contacts

Function	Contact	Hours
Complaint Management System	cms@gtfs.internal	24/7 logging
Customer Experience Team	cx@gtfs.internal	Mon–Fri 8am–8pm
Compliance (regulatory complaints)	compliance@gtfs.internal	24/7 on-call
AML / Fraud Team	aml@gtfs.internal	24/7
Legal	legal@gtfs.internal	Mon–Fri 9am–6pm
Executive Escalation	+65 8000 9300	24/7 Level 4 only

Appendix C — Response Templates

Template	Purpose	Key Content
ACK-001	Acknowledgement	Reference number; severity; SLA; contact officer
UPD-001	Progress update	Status; next steps; expected timeline
RES-001	Final resolution	Outcome; remedy; compensation; 30-day reopening rights
ESC-001	Escalation notice	New contact; escalation reason; revised SLA
SRV-001	Satisfaction survey	Sent within 48 hours post-closure

Appendix D — Complaint Workflow Checklist

- Complaint logged in CMS with category and severity
- Acknowledgement sent within SLA
- Customer updates every 2 business days
- Investigation documented with evidence
- RCA completed (Level 3/4)
- Compensation approved per authority matrix
- Final resolution letter issued
- Satisfaction survey sent within 48 hours
- File retained for 7 years

Appendix E — Customer Communication Standards

Standard	Requirement
Tone	Professional, empathetic, non-defensive
Language	Plain language; avoid internal jargon

Standard	Requirement
Timeliness	All SLAs per severity level
Documentation	All communications logged in CMS
Privacy	Verify customer identity before discussing account details (GTFS-SEC-001)
Escalation	Proactive notification if SLA breach expected within 30 minutes

CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE TIP: Always verify customer identity before discussing complaint details. Refer to GTFS-SEC-001 for secure communication standards.

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